PUBLIC · OK TO SHARE WITH EVERY GUEST

Cast *List*



Everything on these pages is public. Share it before the party or lay it out on the night. Characters 10–15 are in every game; optional characters join from 16 upward.

THE VICTIM (NOT PLAYED)

Vesper Ravensworth, owner of Candlewick Hall, host of the Candlewick Costume Ball and judge of the Costume Parade, dressed as the Queen of Autumn in a crown of paper leaves. Vesper promised "an announcement that will change Candlewick Hollow" at nine o'clock.

THE DETECTIVE (PLAYED BY THE HOST)

Detective Ira Gilchrist, a guest at the ball who happens to solve mysteries. Not a suspect.

Character	Who they are · what they wear
Marlo Quince NO. 10 · MASTER CHANDLER OF CANDLEWICK HALL CORE	Marlo Quince has run the Dipping Room of the candle works for twenty years and keeps the keys to the workshop floor below the Lantern Gallery. Tonight Marlo is giving candle-dipping demonstrations downstairs. Known for steady hands and a very dry sense of humor. *An old friend of Vesper's. Taught Perry Lanthorn to trim a wick.* **Wears:** black cloak, paper flame crown, gold face paint.
Darcy Wickliffe NO. 11 · VESPER'S YOUNGER COUSIN AND HEIR CORE	Darcy Wickliffe, Vesper's younger cousin, grew up running through these halls and is expected to inherit Candlewick Hall one day. Darcy is entering the Costume Parade tonight as "The Golden Sun." Has a family key to every door in the house. *Vesper's only family at the ball. Friendly with everyone; borrows Hadley Cresswell's pencils and never gives them back.* **Wears:** gold "Golden Sun" rays, gold face paint.
Perry Lanthorn NO. 12 · LANTERN-MAKER WHO LIGHTS THE LANTERN GALLERY CORE	Perry Lanthorn makes lanterns in the old stable workshop and has lit the hundred lanterns of the Lantern Gallery every Halloween for eleven years. Perry keeps a key to the gallery and the Back Stairs door, and knows every window latch in the house. *Learned to trim a wick from Marlo Quince. Buys pumpkins from Jory Greaves for lantern night.* **Wears:** long coat, scarf, a lantern, paper moth.

Cast List

CORE & OPTIONAL

Character	Who they are · what they wear
Briar Fallow No. 13 · Costume maker of Candlewick Hollow CORE	Briar Fallow runs the Hollow's little costume shop and stitched half the outfits at tonight's ball, including Jory Greaves's famous fox mask. Briar spends the evening pinning hems for the Costume Parade and never paints faces. *Made costumes for Darcy Wickliffe since Darcy was six. Sold Perry Lanthorn the woolly scarf.* **Wears:** apron, tape measure, safety pins.
Jory Greaves No. 14 · Pumpkin farmer and three-time carving champion CORE	Jory Greaves grows the pumpkins for every Candlewick Ball on the Hall's south field and has won the carving contest three years running. Tonight Jory is lighting the row of jack-o'-lanterns on the terrace. Everyone knows Jory's orange fox mask, made by Briar Fallow. *Sells pumpkins to Perry Lanthorn for lantern night. Wears a fox mask made by Briar Fallow.* **Wears:** orange sweater, black cloak, fox mask.
Hadley Cresswell No. 15 · Editor of the Hollow Gazette CORE	Hadley Cresswell edits the Hollow Gazette, the town's weekly paper, and set up the Gazette's terrace camera to photograph the ball every six minutes. Vesper promised Hadley the first look at tonight's announcement. *Has interviewed every suspect at least once. Lends pencils to Darcy Wickliffe, who never returns them.* **Wears:** trench coat, press card, notebook.
Auden Pryor No. 16 · Town historian and keeper of the Lantern Ghost legend OPTIONAL · 7+ PLAYERS	Auden Pryor is the Hollow's town historian and the person who tells the Legend of the Lantern Ghost every year. Auden spent much of tonight in the Hall's library with the old candle-works ledgers. *Has written about Perry Lanthorn's lanterns and Jory Greaves's pumpkins in Hadley Cresswell's Gazette.* **Wears:** tweed jacket, scarf, old book.
Bexley Applegate No. 17 · Owner of the Applegate Cider Press OPTIONAL · 8+ PLAYERS	Bexley Applegate runs the Applegate cider press and serves the ball's hot apple cider (alcohol-free, as always) from the big urn in the front hall. Bexley also stocks the little cider kettle in the Lantern Gallery for Vesper. *Old customer of Jory Greaves. Fills Hadley Cresswell's thermos every Monday morning.* **Wears:** flannel, apron, a ladle.
Corin Thimble No. 18 · Fiddler and leader of the ball's band OPTIONAL · 9+ PLAYERS	Corin Thimble leads the band from the musicians' balcony above the ballroom and calls the tune for the Costume Parade. Corin has played every Candlewick Ball for nine years. *Plays the march for Darcy Wickliffe's and Briar Fallow's parade line-up. Hadley Cresswell reviews the band every year.* **Wears:** waistcoat, ribbon bow tie, a fiddle.

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Character	Who they are · what they wear
Larkin Hearthstone No. 19 · Baker of the Candlewick pumpkin pies Optional · 10+ players	Larkin Hearthstone bakes the pumpkin pies served at ten o'clock every year. Tonight Larkin spent most of the evening in the Hall's kitchen with twenty-four pies. *Buys pumpkins from Jory Greaves and apples from Bexley Applegate.* **Wears:** apron, flour, rolling pin.
Teagan Bramwell No. 20 · Groundskeeper of Candlewick Hall Optional · 11+ players	Teagan Bramwell keeps the grounds of Candlewick Hall and carries a ring of forty keys. Tonight Teagan spent the evening at the gate, guiding cars and lighting the drive. *Helps Perry Lanthorn carry lanterns every Halloween. Mows Jory Greaves's field edge.* **Wears:** barn coat, gloves, ring of keys.
Ainsley Duskwood No. 21 · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only) Optional · 12+ players	Ainsley Duskwood runs the fortune booth at the ball every year: a stage act with a tablecloth, a glass bowl and a lot of guesswork. Tonight the booth stood in the conservatory, with a queue all evening. *Read Darcy Wickliffe's "fortune" at last year's ball. Borrowed a black cloak from Briar Fallow's shop.* **Wears:** starry black cloak, bangles, head scarf.
Merritt Oxley No. 22 · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers Optional · 13+ players	Merritt Oxley is the town clerk of Candlewick Hollow and arrived tonight carrying a sealed folder for Vesper, to be opened at nine o'clock. *Knows Hadley Cresswell from every town meeting. Has signed Teagan Bramwell's gate permits.* **Wears:** blazer, folder, fountain pen.
Wynn Pennywhistle No. 23 · Photographer of the costume parade Optional · 14+ players	Wynn Pennywhistle photographs the Costume Parade winners every year. Tonight Wynn set up the winners' backdrop in the portrait room upstairs. *Photographed Darcy Wickliffe's first costume at age six. Shares darkroom tips with Hadley Cresswell.* **Wears:** dark clothes, camera, backward cap.

The setting

Candlewick Hall, the old candle works on the hill above the town of Candlewick Hollow. The **Ballroom** opens onto the **Lantern Gallery**, a long corridor with nine tall windows facing the **terrace**. At the gallery's far end are the **Coat Room** and the **Back Stairs**, which lead down to the workshop floor: the **Dipping Room** and the **Stockroom**. Vesper's **study** opens off the gallery.